BEYOND CHIAVARI · FREE PLANNING KIT

Corporate Event Planning Kit

For HR, marketing, and operations teams running conferences, galas, client dinners, and team events.

Corporate events succeed when the goals are clear, the logistics are tight, and the guest experience feels effortless. This kit walks you from the first brief to post-event ROI, with checklists for venues, AV, registration, accessibility, and dietary needs. Use it to keep stakeholders aligned and vendors accountable.

INSIDE

1. Event Brief and Goals Worksheet
2. Corporate Event Timeline
3. Venue Questions
4. AV and Room Setup Styles
5. Registration and Check-in Checklist
6. Budget per Person
7. Accessibility and Dietary Checklist
8. Post-event ROI Checklist



beyondchiavari.com
Chairs, tables, linens, tents and more across Chicagoland, on one quote.

PART 1

Event Brief and Goals Worksheet

Complete this first and get sign-off from your stakeholders before you book anything.

EVENT NAME AND FORMAT (CONFERENCE, DINNER, RETREAT, LAUNCH)

PRIMARY GOAL IN ONE SENTENCE

SECONDARY GOALS

TARGET AUDIENCE AND INVITEE LIST SIZE

EXPECTED ATTENDANCE

SUCCESS MEASURES (SIGN-UPS, LEADS, SATISFACTION SCORE)

DATE OPTIONS AND EVENT LENGTH

TOTAL BUDGET AND APPROVER

PREFERRED LOCATION OR NEIGHBORHOOD

REQUIRED SPEAKERS OR GUESTS OF HONOR

EXECUTIVE SPONSOR

KEY STAKEHOLDERS AND SIGN-OFF DEADLINE

BRANDING AND TONE NOTES

RISKS AND CONSTRAINTS

PART 2

Corporate Event Timeline

Adjust for event size. Conferences with 300 or more guests often need 6 to 9 months of lead time.

4 to 6 months out

- [ ] Finalize goals, budget, and approval process with leadership.
- [ ] Pick two or three possible dates, avoiding major Chicago conventions, holidays, and school breaks.
- [ ] Issue a venue request for proposal and tour top choices.
- [ ] Sign the venue contract after legal review.
- [ ] Build a master timeline and assign owners to every task.
- [ ] Book keynote speakers, hosts, and talent.

3 months out

- [ ] Launch the registration page and open the invitation.
- [ ] Book catering and confirm menu direction.
- [ ] Reserve AV, staging, and lighting vendors.
- [ ] Reserve rentals: tables, chairs, linens, tent, lounge furniture, and signage.
- [ ] Plan transportation and parking for attendees.
- [ ] Negotiate a hotel room block if guests travel.

2 months out

- [ ] Confirm the agenda, session titles, and speaker bios.
- [ ] Collect speaker slides and AV requirements.
- [ ] Send reminders and track registration numbers weekly.
- [ ] Order printed materials, badges, and swag.
- [ ] Plan the accessibility and dietary processes.
- [ ] Secure photography, video, and social media coverage.

1 month out

- [ ] Finalize the floor plan, room layouts, and seating.
- [ ] Send attendee logistics emails with parking, dress code, and agenda.
- [ ] Confirm headcount estimates with the caterer.
- [ ] Hold a vendor coordination call to align on load-in and rehearsal.
- [ ] Print signage, name badges, and seating charts.
- [ ] Test the registration and check-in system.

2 weeks out

- [ ] Send the final headcount to catering, venue, and rental partners.
- [ ] Distribute the run of show to staff, vendors, and speakers.
- [ ] Confirm emergency contacts and a safety plan.
- [ ] Assign staff roles and shifts.
- [ ] Prepare onsite kits and registration materials.
- [ ] Check the weather and arrange a rain plan for any outdoor component.

Event week

- [ ] Confirm every vendor arrival time.
- [ ] Walk the venue and test all AV equipment.
- [ ] Brief the staff and volunteers.
- [ ] Rehearse key sessions and speeches.
- [ ] Prepare the final attendee list at registration.
- [ ] Pack the emergency kit.

Day of

- [ ] Arrive early for load-in and setup.
- [ ] Inspect the rental delivery and count items.
- [ ] Run a final tech check.
- [ ] Open registration before the first attendee arrives.
- [ ] Keep communication open with a group chat or radios.
- [ ] Keep a running log of issues for the post-event debrief.

After the event

- [ ] Confirm rental pickup and count returned items.
- [ ] Pay final invoices and collect receipts.
- [ ] Send a thank-you message and survey within 48 hours.
- [ ] Share photos and recordings.
- [ ] Hold an internal debrief within one week.
- [ ] Deliver a post-event report to stakeholders.

PART 3

Venue Questions

1. What is the maximum capacity for each room in theater, banquet, and reception styles?
2. What is included in the rental fee, and what is extra?
3. Is there a food and beverage minimum, and can we bring in outside catering?
4. What AV equipment is included, and can we bring our own vendor?
5. What are the load-in and load-out times, and is there a freight elevator?
6. Is there reliable Wi-Fi for the expected number of devices, and what is the bandwidth?
7. Are there power drops and enough outlets in each room?
8. What are the accessibility features: ramps, elevators, restrooms, and parking?
9. What is the policy on signage, banners, and branded displays?
10. Is there on-site parking, valet, or nearby garage pricing?
11. What is the cancellation and rescheduling policy?
12. Do you require certificates of insurance from vendors?

PART 4

AV and Room Setup Styles

Space per person is approximate. Always confirm with your venue and rental company.

Setup style	Space per person	Best for	Rental notes
Theater	8 to 10 sq ft	Keynotes and large presentations	Chairs only. Add a stage and podium.
Classroom	18 to 22 sq ft	Training and note-taking	6 ft tables and chairs facing front.
Banquet rounds	10 to 12 sq ft	Meals, awards, and gala dinners	60 in or 66 in rounds with linens.
Boardroom	25 to 30 sq ft	Small meetings up to 20	Conference table and comfortable chairs.
U-shape	30 to 40 sq ft	Workshops and discussions	Tables in a U with chairs on the outside.
Hollow square	25 to 30 sq ft	Collaborative meetings	Tables in a square, chairs around the outside.
Cabaret	15 to 18 sq ft	Panels and entertainment with food	Rounds with chairs on one side only.
Reception or cocktail	6 to 8 sq ft	Networking and standing events	Cocktail tables and lounge seating.

PART 5

Registration and Check-in Checklist

REGISTRATION SETUP

- [ ] Choose a registration platform that handles tickets, payments, and attendee data.
- [ ] Create a clear registration form that captures name, company, dietary needs, and accessibility needs.
- [ ] Set up confirmation emails with a calendar invite and event details.
- [ ] Include a code of conduct and photography policy.
- [ ] Set a registration cutoff date.
- [ ] Create a waitlist process if you reach capacity.

CHECK-IN PREP

- [ ] Print badges alphabetically or by company.
- [ ] Prepare a list of VIPs, speakers, and sponsors who need special handling.
- [ ] Set up check-in tables with signs and a clear queue.
- [ ] Provide a separate line for on-site registration.
- [ ] Test the scanners, tablets, and Wi-Fi at the check-in area.
- [ ] Create a backup paper list in case technology fails.

ON THE DAY

- [ ] Open registration at least 30 minutes before the start.
- [ ] Greet each attendee and hand out the badge, agenda, and any swag.
- [ ] Direct attendees to coat check, restrooms, and the first session.
- [ ] Track no-shows and walk-ins in real time.
- [ ] Assign a floater to solve any problems quickly.
- [ ] Close registration after the first session begins and reconcile the list.

PART 6

Budget per Person

Typical split for a seated evening event. Rough Chicago-area guidance only. Costs vary by venue, season, and format.



Category	Share	Your budget: $_____	Tip
Venue and rentals	25%	$_____	Include tables, chairs, linens, tent, staging, and lighting. Get an all-in quote.
Food and beverage	35%	$_____	Confirm service charge, gratuity, and tax in the per-person price.
AV and production	12%	$_____	Include microphones, projection, lighting, and a technician on site.
Speakers and entertainment	8%	$_____	Negotiate travel costs and overtime in the contract.
Marketing, printing, and signage	6%	$_____	Prioritize clear directional signage and branded badges.
Registration and technology	4%	$_____	Platform fees often scale by ticket.
Staffing and transportation	5%	$_____	Include valet, shuttles, and security.

Category	Share	Your budget: $_____	Tip
Contingency	5%	$_____	Hold this until the event is over.

PART 7

Accessibility and Dietary Checklist

ACCESSIBILITY

- [ ] Ask about accessibility needs on the registration form.
- [ ] Choose a venue with step-free entry, accessible restrooms, and elevators.
- [ ] Leave 36 in minimum clear paths between tables and chairs.
- [ ] Reserve accessible seating near the front and aisle seats for those who need them.
- [ ] Provide large-print agendas and captioning or sign language interpreters when requested.
- [ ] Offer a quiet room for guests who need a break.
- [ ] Reserve accessible parking spaces close to the entrance.
- [ ] Train staff on how to assist guests respectfully.

DIETARY NEEDS

- [ ] Collect dietary requirements and allergies in advance.
- [ ] Offer vegetarian, vegan, gluten-free, dairy-free, and nut-free options.
- [ ] Label every dish clearly with ingredients and major allergens.
- [ ] Separate prep and serving utensils for allergen-free dishes.
- [ ] Provide kosher, halal, or other specialized meals if requested.
- [ ] Brief the catering team on severe allergies.
- [ ] Mark special meals on the seating chart and badges.
- [ ] Offer water, non-alcoholic drinks, and coffee at all times.

PART 8

Post-event ROI Checklist

COLLECT DATA

- [ ] Send a short survey within 48 hours with 5 to 8 questions.
- [ ] Record final attendance against registrations and no-show rate.
- [ ] Track leads generated, meetings booked, or deals influenced.
- [ ] Collect social media mentions and photos.
- [ ] Gather vendor and staff feedback.

MEASURE RESULTS

- [ ] Compare actual spend with the budget and note variances.
- [ ] Calculate cost per attendee and cost per qualified lead.
- [ ] Compare outcomes with the goals set in the brief.
- [ ] Identify the top three sessions or moments from feedback.
- [ ] Identify the top three problems and root causes.

REPORT AND FOLLOW UP

- [ ] Send thank-you emails to attendees, speakers, and sponsors.
- [ ] Share a summary report with key stakeholders within two weeks.
- [ ] Add notes to the contact database and assign follow-up tasks.
- [ ] Update the event playbook with lessons learned.
- [ ] Archive contracts, invoices, and photos for future events.

NEXT STEP

Get every rental on one quote

Pick chairs, tables, linens, dinnerware, tents and decor from Chicago-area rental companies and see prices as you build your list at beyondchiavari.com/quote. Want a second set of eyes on your plan? Book a free planning call at beyondchiavari.com/book.

Planning rules of thumb only. Confirm counts, rules and timing with your venue and vendors. © Beyond Chiavari. Free to print and share for personal planning.